

Cold Lunch

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ABSTRACT

The lunch bell rings at an elementary school and a flurry of arms grasp at brown paper bags. One Korean-American girl is surprised to find a tupperware full of Japchae noodles in her backpack when all her friends brought sandwiches. Feeling out of place, she conceals her noodles, but her lunch refuses to hide, instead transforming into a dragon made of noodles. Immediately, it is excited to meet everyone, flying out of the classroom at the sound of laughter. The girl desperately chases it down the hall and barely manages to trap the dragon in her lunchbox. When the dragon stops struggling,

the girl carefully opens her lunchbox and the dragon looks up at her, hurt by her rejection. She apologizes, and the dragon forgives her. It lifts a compartment in her lunchbox lid to reveal three sets of chopsticks, as the food was made to be shared. The girl's face lights up with hope, and the dragon returns to its place in the lunchbox, becoming regular Japchae noodles. With newfound courage, the girl shows her lunch to her friends. Her friends are excited to see this new meal, and in the end, they share food and eat lunch together.

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